

To help Claude generate the most effective Upwork proposal possible, you should provide a highly structured prompt that incorporates the **strategic logic** found in the sources.

To ensure Claude "fully understands" the task, feed it the following **four specific components** in a single message:

1. The Strategic Role & Objective

Tell Claude exactly who it is representing and what the goal is.

- **The Instruction:** "You are an elite freelancer on Upwork who has earned over \$1 million. Your goal is to write a cover letter that 'traps' the client into reading it by focusing entirely on their perspective and goals, not just my skills 1-3."

2. The Raw Context Data (The "Feeder" Info)

Claude cannot personalize the letter without the "ingredients." You must paste the following directly into the chat:

- **The Job Description:** Paste the full text of the Upwork posting.
- **Client Name/History:** If you found the client's name in their feedback history, provide it 4, 5.
- **Your "Relevance" List:** Provide a list of your best work samples. Tell Claude: "From this list of my projects, select only the **3 to 5 samples** that strictly match this specific job's requirements 6, 7."
- **Logistics:** Provide your turnaround time (e.g., 48 hours) and your specific niche specialty 8, 9.

3. The 5-Step Structural Framework

Explicitly command Claude to follow the **Strategic Cover Letter Blueprint**:

- **The Hook (The First Two Sentences):** "The first two sentences are the most important because that is all the client sees initially 4, 10. Start with a personalized greeting. Then, state the client's goal (e.g., increasing retention) and a specific strategy to achieve it 3, 11."
- **Evidence (Work Samples):** "Present 3–5 bulleted work samples that align perfectly with the description 7. Use the format: 'Project Title - Link/Description' 8, 9."
- **Value Proposition:** "Clearly state what I can deliver (X) and by when (Y). Highlight a specific skill that solves their main problem 8, 9."
- **The Call to Action (CTA):** "End with a request for a **10-minute introduction call** this week to see if we are a good fit 9, 12, 13."

4. Constraints for Quality Control

To prevent Claude from being too "wordy" or generic, add these constraints:

- **Be Concise:** "Keep the letter concise and to the point. Avoid fluff 7."
- **Client-Centric Language:** "Focus on the outcomes the client wants (e.g., more views, more money) rather than just listing my skills 3, 14, 15."
- **The "Rule of 15":** Tell Claude to remind you to check the "Activity on this job" section. It should only finalize the letter if there are **fewer than 15 proposals** and the client has checked the post within the **last week** 16–18.

Example of what to say to Claude:

"I am going to provide a job description and my portfolio. I want you to act as a million-dollar freelancer. Using the **5-step winning proposal strategy**, write a cover letter.

Focus: The first two sentences must be a powerful hook addressing their goal of insert goal.**Selection:** Choose the 3 most relevant samples from my list.**Closing:** Ask for a 10-minute intro call.**Rule:** Do not use generic corporate language; talk like a partner interested in their business growth 3, 15."

Note on Notion: As mentioned in the sources, do not try to give Claude a link to a Notion page, as it may fail due to **JavaScript errors 19, 20**. Always **copy and paste** the text directly into the chat to ensure Claude has full access to your data.